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Agenda item 71

Promotion and protection of human rights

Cabo Verde, Costa Rica, Morocco and Sierra Leone:* draft resolution

International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage

The General Assembly,

Reaffirming the Charter of the United Nations and its purposes and principles,

Reaffirming also the Universal Declaration of Human Rights,¹ the Convention on the Rights of the Child² and its Optional Protocols,³ the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women,⁴ the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights⁵ and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights,⁶

Recalling its resolutions [69/156](#) of 18 December 2014, [71/175](#) of 19 December 2016, [73/153](#) of 17 December 2018, [75/167](#) of 16 December 2020, [77/202](#) of 15 December 2022 and [79/158](#) of 17 December 2024 on child, early and forced marriage,

Recalling also its resolutions [53/199](#) of 15 December 1998 and [61/185](#) of 20 December 2006 on the proclamation of international years, and Economic and Social Council resolution [1980/67](#) of 25 July 1980 on international years and anniversaries,

Recalling further the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development,⁷ and noting in particular target 5.3 thereof, which calls for the elimination of all harmful practices, including child, early and forced marriage, as well as the pledge to leave no one behind,

* Any changes to the list of sponsors will be reflected in the official record of the meeting.

¹ Resolution [217 A \(III\)](#).

² United Nations, *Treaty Series*, vol. 1577, No. 27531.

³ Ibid., vols. 2171, 2173 and 2983, No. 27531.

⁴ Ibid., vol. 1249, No. 20378.

⁵ See resolution [2200 A \(XXI\)](#), annex.

⁶ Ibid.

⁷ Resolution [70/1](#).



Recognizing that child, early and forced marriage is a harmful practice that violates, abuses or impairs human rights, disproportionately affecting women and girls, particularly those in vulnerable situations, and threatening their education, health, economic opportunities and full enjoyment of human rights,

Recognizing also that, in some regions and contexts, the practice of child, early and forced marriage may include other arrangements, including informal unions, that are not formalized, registered or recognized by a religious, customary or State authority, and that such arrangements should be addressed and eliminated in policies and programmes to prevent, address and eliminate child, early and forced marriage,

Acknowledging the efforts of Member States that have strengthened laws, policies and programmes, and the role of regional organizations and civil society with a view to preventing and eliminating child, early and forced marriage,

Recognizing that dedicated international observances serve as catalysts for global awareness, political mobilization, accountability and the sharing of good practices, and that no United Nations international day is currently designated specifically to end child, early and forced marriage,

1. *Decides* to proclaim 27 November of each year as the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage;

2. *Invites* all Member States, entities of the United Nations system, international and regional organizations, religious leaders, civil society, academic institutions, the private sector and other relevant stakeholders to observe the Day in an appropriate manner, including through education, public awareness and advocacy activities aimed at preventing child, early and forced marriage, supporting victims and survivors and promoting accountability;

3. *Encourages* Member States to continue to develop and implement holistic, multisectoral national strategies and action plans to end child, early and forced marriage;

4. *Also encourages* Member States to voluntarily share information and best practices, including through public events and national initiatives, on concrete measures undertaken to prevent and eliminate child, early and forced marriage;

5. *Calls upon* Member States to invest in quality education for all girls, including programmes enabling married girls and young women to continue or return to education, and to promote the empowerment of women and girls as a key strategy for prevention;

6. *Stresses* that the cost of all activities that may arise from the implementation of the present resolution should be met by voluntary contributions and that such activities would be subject to the availability and provision of voluntary contributions;

7. *Requests* the Secretary-General to bring the present resolution to the attention of all Member States and relevant entities of the United Nations system and to facilitate the observance of the International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage.